

Payout Operations v1

Verification · Hold periods · TDS · GST · Approvals · Reconciliation · Edge cases

Yeh finance team ka operating manual hai. Ledger design alag doc mein hai — yeh uske upar ka process hai.

1. Host verification

Chaar cheezein mandatory, payout unlock hone se pehle:

Step	Kya	Kyun
PAN	Number + name match	TDS ke liye zaroori. Bina PAN 20% TDS
Bank account	Penny drop (₹1 bhejo, name confirm karo)	Galat account mein paisa jaana sabse mehngi galti
Face match	Selfie vs PAN photo	Account takeover aur mule accounts rokta hai
Age check	PAN se DOB	18+ enforcement

Rules

- Bank account ka naam PAN se match hona chahiye. Mismatch = manual review
- **Ek PAN = ek host account.** Duplicate PAN detect karo
- Bank account change par **14 din cooling period**, payout hold — yeh account takeover ka sabse common attack vector hai

2. Points → payout flow

Points earned → Hold period → Withdrawable balance
→ Request raise → Risk check → Approval → Batch → Bank

Hold period

Host	Hold
Standard	7 din
Naya host (< 30 din)	14 din

Yeh chargeback protection hai — user recharge karke gift bhejta hai, phir card chargeback file karta hai. Agar host tab tak withdraw kar chuka toh paisa gaya.

Limits

Minimum	₹1,000
Maximum per request	₹2,00,000
Frequency	Hafte mein ek baar
Processing	2-3 working days

Weekly batching rakho, daily nahi — bank charges kam, reconciliation aasan, aur fraud detect karne ka time milta hai.

3. TDS handling

Section decide karo — CA se, likhit mein

	194J	194-O
Rate	10%	1%
Threshold	₹50,000/year	₹5 lakh (individual/HUF)
Logic	Aap host ki professional service kharid rahe ho	Aap e-commerce operator ho jo service facilitate kar raha hai

Zyada tar creator platforms 194-O ki taraf jaate hain. **Yeh CA ka call hai — decision likhit mein lo aur file mein rakho.** Assessment ke waqt yahi bachaega.

System requirements

- Running total per host per financial year
- Threshold cross hone par **poore amount par** TDS, sirf excess par nahi
- No PAN → 20% automatically
- Har payout par TDS entry ledger mein
- Quarterly TDS return export (Form 26Q)
- **Form 16A generation** per host, quarterly

4. GST branching

	GST-registered host	Non-registered host
Kaun	Turnover > ₹20 lakh	~99% hosts
Invoice	Woh aapko GST invoice deta hai	Koi invoice nahi
Aap pay karte ho	Amount + 18% GST	Sirf amount
Input credit	Haan	Nahi
TDS calculate	Amount par (GST excluding)	Amount par

System mein: `gst_in` optional field. Agar bhara hai toh GST portal API se verify karo, payout mein 18% add karo, aur self-billing invoice generate karo.

5. Approval — maker-checker

Non-negotiable. System-level enforcement, policy nahi.

```
Finance operator  → batch prepare, review, submit
Finance approver  → verify, approve ya reject
System            → bank file generate
```

Ek hi banda dono nahi kar sakta.

Auto-approve rules

Volume handle karne ke liye — auto-approve tabhi jab **sab** sach hon:

- Amount < ₹10,000
- Verified host
- Account 90+ din purana
- Zero risk flags

Manual review triggers

- Amount > ₹50,000
- Naya bank account (< 30 din)
- Risk score above threshold
- Pehli baar withdraw
- Agency host jiske gifts sirf ek user se aaye hon

6. Payment rails

Method	Cost	Speed	Kab use karein
UPI	₹0-2	Instant	₹1 lakh tak — sabse sasta, default
IMPS	₹5-10	Instant	₹5 lakh tak
NEFT	₹2-5	Same day	Bulk batches
RTGS	₹20-50	Instant	₹2 lakh+

Providers: RazorpayX · Cashfree Payouts · Decentro

Bank ka direct API bhi option hai par integration slow hai — launch ke liye aggregator behtar.

Failure handling

Har payout ka status track karo: `initiated → processing → success | failed`

Fail hone par:

- Points wapas ledger mein credit (reversal txn, original edit nahi)
- Host ko notify with reason
- Bank account issue ho toh re-verification trigger

7. Daily reconciliation

Roz subah automated, aur mismatch par **pager alert**:

Check	Kya verify karta hai
Ledger balance	Har account ka sum entries se match kare
Txn balance	Har transaction ke entries ka sum = 0
Coin float	Issued – spent = outstanding liability
Payout vs bank	Kal ke payouts bank statement se match
Recharge vs gateway	Kal ke recharges PG settlement se match
Points issued vs gifts	Gift value × payout rate = points credited

Chhota mismatch bade bug ka symptom hota hai. **Ignore mat karna.**

8. Edge cases — pehle se decide karo

Case	Policy
Host ban, balance pending	L1 violation = forfeit. L2-L3 = payout allowed. ToS mein pehle se likho
Host account abandoned	12 mahine inactive → notification → 24 mahine par forfeit ya escheat. CA se confirm
User chargeback, host withdraw kar chuka	Platform loss bear kare. Host se clawback mat karo — relationship kharab hota hai
Host ki death	Legal heir claim, succession certificate
Wrong account mein paisa	Bank recall request. Fault kiski thi — process document karo
Duplicate payout (bug)	Idempotency key se rokna. Ho jaaye toh clawback + incident review
Host agency badal raha hai	Commission gift ke timestamp par split, current link par nahi

9. Team aur cost

Stage	Team	Effort
Launch (< 200 hosts)	Founder + CA	4-6 hrs/week
500 hosts	1 finance ops (part-time)	Daily
2,000 hosts	1 operator + 1 approver	Full-time
10,000 hosts	3-4 finance team	Full-time

Transaction cost: ~₹8 per payout. ₹50L monthly payout volume par ~₹15-20K/month.

10. Build checklist

- ☐ PAN capture + format validation
- ☐ Bank penny-drop integration
- ☐ Face match at verification
- ☐ Bank change cooling period (14 din)
- ☐ Hold period logic (7 / 14 din)
- ☐ Withdrawal request flow + limits

- ☐ TDS running total per host per FY
- ☐ TDS calculation with no-PAN 20% branch
- ☐ GST branching (gst in field + 18% add)
- ☐ Maker-checker approval workflow
- ☐ Auto-approve rules engine
- ☐ Payout provider integration (RazorpayX / Cashfree)
- ☐ Status tracking + failure reversal
- ☐ Daily reconciliation job + alerting
- ☐ Form 26Q export
- ☐ Form 16A generation
- ☐ Self-billing invoice for GST hosts